Los Baños El Niño — One-Page Summary

3 October 2026 · Siddharth Kaul· From the verified El Niño action briefing of 2 October 2026

Bottom line

El Niño gives Los Baños (117,030 people, 14 barangays) a long dry season into mid-2027, confirmed by PAGASA on 26 August 2026. The threat with the most evidence is dengue from water stored during shortages; the recurring failure in past El Niños is help arriving after the crisis.

- **Scale of harm:** deaths will be few, roughly 1–2 from dengue a year by our estimate. Climate Impact Lab's heat figure covers Southeast Asia as a whole (19,400); scaled to Los Baños it is about 7, our arithmetic.
- **The calendar that matters:** dry-season peak January–March; heat index peaks March–May; dengue season June–November.

What to do

Six actions carry most of the plan, ranked by lives saved per unit of effort.

#	Action	Owner	By when
1	Dengue warning-sign triage and same-day referral at every barangay health station, all year	Municipal Health Office, barangay health workers	1 Nov 2026
2	Weekly container control on stored water (lids, scrub, empty); no routine fogging	Barangay health workers, SK volunteers	Weekly from Nov
3	Map wells and pressure points; pre-contract water tankers	MDRRMO, water provider (likely Los Baños Water District)	15 Jan 2027
4	List drought-relief recipients, farmers and fisherfolk first	MSWDO, MDRRMO, DSWD IV-A	31 Dec 2026
5	Write a trigger into a calamity resolution; fund preparedness from the disaster fund now	Mayor and Sangguniang Bayan	Oct–Nov 2026
6	Barangay heat registry, checks and cooled halls on PAGASA "Danger" days	Barangay captains, tanods, health workers	31 Jan 2027

Also: enrol farmers and fisherfolk in free crop insurance before planting, and shift school hours on Danger days rather than closing schools. **The single highest-value meeting is a briefing for all 14 barangay captains**, who do the work on most rows.

Money and what not to do

Funding: $40,000 floor, ~$138,000 target, ~$319,000 ceiling. The floor is the life-saving part: $25,000 to the Municipal Health Office for dengue and $15,000 for barangay heat checks. Above it, the money is livelihood cash for fisherfolk and farmers (about $235 per household by GCash). No pre-arranged drought money is confirmed for Laguna, so before releasing anything, ask the MDRRMO what the town's disaster fund (~₱23.8m, our upper-bound estimate) already covers and how many dengue cases it logged in 2023–24.

Do not:

- Fog routinely: mosquitoes in neighbouring Metro Manila resist the standard insecticides.
- Advise storing water without lids, or drill new wells near the lake, where groundwater pumping is sinking the ground.
- Count on cloud seeding.
- Close schools outright on heat days.
- Judge fans by the heat index: the 35 °C limit is air temperature, and local highs average 29–31 °C, so fans with wet skin still help on most days.

Full verified briefing, with sources and the RACI chart: elnino-actions/los-banos-laguna-philippines-actions.html (2 October 2026). Climate Impact Lab figures are pre-peer-review. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.